

1.4 Chat or Wizard?

You may be asking yourself whether you need a paid AI coding subscription, or whether free web services such as ChatGPT and Anthropic Claude are sufficient. First of all, the question is incomplete in this form: provided you have a powerful computer, you can also implement the coding wizard functions with local language models, that is, without a subscription. We'll go into this topic in more detail in [Chapter 9](#). This avoids both the subscription and data protection concerns. However, costs are still incurred—either for you privately or for your company: you need an expensive computer, which in turn needs more power, and so on.

But regardless of the details of how you implement your code wizard, the basic question still remains: Would you prefer to work chat-based or follow the ideas of a wizard without being asked while you're entering code? In our everyday lives, a combination of both techniques has become the established approach. Now that we've become accustomed to the convenience of a coding wizard, we no longer want to do without these functions. Nevertheless, we often find it useful to research basic questions (less code details, but rather strategic considerations) in a chat window or web browser, separated from the editor or the development environment.

But the question of whether you need a chat or assistant also has to do with personal preferences. Of course, it's more complicated to find out details in the chat first and then implement them manually in the code. Frequent copying and pasting is a major source of errors, for example, if variable and function names suddenly no longer match. Nevertheless, this workflow gives you better control over your code. Ultimately, you're responsible for your code and must understand it.

Further Reading

You can read an extremely exciting interview about various applications of AI tools in the “Building a Text Editor in the Times of AI” article here:

<https://zed.dev/blog/building-a-text-editor-in-times-of-ai>.

In the interview, the developers of the Zed editor describe how they use AI tools themselves and how they integrate AI functions into the new editor.